

D807

General Secondary Methods

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

During a lab in a tenth-grade chemistry class, a student who earns strong grades mixes two chemicals early after friends dare him. The school just added a new parking lot and the class had a fire drill that morning. How should the teacher interpret the behavior when planning next steps?

- A. As a result of stress from the morning fire drill.
- B. As a typical adolescent impulse under peer pressure, to be addressed with clear safety steps, structure, and a planning check before labs.
- C. As defiance that always requires removal from all future labs.
- D. As proof that the student lacks ability in chemistry.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A ninth-grade civics teacher with a large collection of classroom posters notices that students disengage during a unit on local government. Several ask, why do we even need to know this? The unit is scheduled for three weeks. Which adjustment best reflects adolescent identity development?

- A. Treat the question as disrespect and assign detention.
- B. Shorten the unit to one week so students are bored for less time.
- C. Add more posters about government to the walls.
- D. Let students choose a local issue that affects them and investigate how local government could address it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

An eighth-grade math teacher who recently moved from another state introduces the idea that a variable can stand for any number. Students stare blankly at the general rule. The teacher's room has new interactive whiteboards. What is the best next step?

- A. Start with concrete examples, such as a table of costs for 1, 2, and 3 items, then build to the general rule.
- B. Repeat the abstract definition more slowly.
- C. Use the interactive whiteboard to display the definition in larger text.
- D. Assume all eighth graders reason abstractly and move on.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student can correctly solve $3 + x = 10$ and $5 + x = 12$ but cannot explain what $a + x = b$ means. What does this show?

- A.** Abstract reasoning is still developing; the student needs help linking concrete cases to the general form.
- B.** The student does not understand addition.
- C.** The student will never understand algebra.
- D.** The student has fully reached abstract reasoning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Halfway through a unit, a biology teacher who runs the school garden club gives a 10-question quiz on cell organelles. It is printed on bright green paper. She uses the results to regroup students for the next two days of review. How is this quiz being used?

- A.** As a summative assessment, because every quiz counts as a final grade.
- B.** As a diagnostic pre-assessment given before the unit.
- C.** Formatively, because the results guide the next lessons.
- D.** Summatively, because it is a quiz with a score.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher gives the same 10-question quiz but records it as the unit grade and starts the next unit the following day. How is it being used now?

- A.** Formatively, because it is the same quiz as before.
- B.** Diagnostically.
- C.** Summatively.
- D.** As a performance assessment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An English teacher with 150 students across five periods wants all students to analyze how an author builds suspense. Some students read well above grade level, and some are still building fluency. The school library was recently remodeled. Which plan best differentiates?

- A. Ask students still building fluency to summarize the plot instead of analyzing suspense.
- B. Have advanced readers analyze three extra stories while others do one.
- C. Send all students to the new library to pick any book.
- D. Offer texts at different reading levels, all with suspense, and let students show their analysis in writing or a recorded explanation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Students in a history class all read the same article on the causes of a war. Some write an essay, some build an annotated timeline, and some record a podcast explaining the causes. Which element of instruction is being differentiated?

- A. Learning environment.
- B. The learning goal.
- C. Product.
- D. Content.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A health teacher whose classroom faces the football field writes an objective for a unit on nutrition: Students will choose to read food labels on their own and explain why doing so matters to them. The unit uses a new online textbook. Which domain and level does this objective target?

- A. Affective domain, receiving.
- B. Cognitive domain, application.
- C. Psychomotor domain, because students handle food labels.
- D. Affective domain, valuing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants an objective at the lowest level of the affective domain. Which fits?

- A.** Students will listen attentively while classmates share views on recycling.
- B.** Students will organize their values about recycling into a personal plan.
- C.** Students will list three benefits of recycling.
- D.** Students will consistently act on a personal code of environmental responsibility.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A history teacher who has used a popular free AI chatbot for two years wants to speed up feedback. He plans to paste students' essays, with their full names and ID numbers, into the chatbot. The chatbot has millions of users. What should he do first?

- A.** Never use AI for any teaching purpose.
- B.** Check district policy for approved tools and remove identifying information before using any AI tool.
- C.** Proceed, since a tool with millions of users must be safe.
- D.** Proceed, but only with essays from students who earned high grades.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A science teacher moves from a school with 50-minute periods to a school with 90-minute blocks. His new school is in a larger district with a well-known robotics program. How should he adjust his lesson planning?

- A.** Teach two of his old 50-minute lessons back to back with no changes.
- B.** Plan several shorter segments, such as a warm-up, mini-lesson, hands-on work, and closure, with movement between them.
- C.** Add robotics to every lesson because the district is known for it.
- D.** Lecture for the full 90 minutes to cover more content.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

During a lab in a tenth-grade chemistry class, a student who earns strong grades mixes two chemicals early after friends dare him. ~~The school just added a new parking lot and the class had a fire drill that morning.~~ How should the teacher interpret the behavior when planning next steps?

Target word: developmental explanation for risky choice **Decides:** Peer presence plus a still-maturing prefrontal cortex increases impulsive risk-taking.

A	Camouflage	The drill is irrelevant; the dare decides it.
B	Correct	Matches adolescent brain development and responds with structure.
C	Absolute language	A permanent response ignores development and teaching.
D	Adjacent category	Confuses impulse control with academic ability; his grades are strong.

2. Answer D Concept 2

A ninth-grade civics teacher ~~with a large collection of classroom posters~~ notices that students disengage during a unit on local government. Several ask, why do we even need to know this? ~~The unit is scheduled for three weeks.~~ Which adjustment best reflects adolescent identity development?

Target word: engagement through identity and voice **Decides:** Students are asking for personal relevance.

A	Inverted operation	Punishes a developmental need for meaning.
B	Dropped element	Cuts time without adding relevance.
C	Camouflage	Room decoration does not create relevance.
D	Correct	Choice and relevance support identity formation and engagement.

3. Answer A Concept 3

An eighth-grade math teacher ~~who recently moved from another state~~ introduces the idea that a variable can stand for any number. Students stare blankly at the general rule. ~~The teacher's room has new interactive whiteboards.~~ What is the best next step?

Target word: bridge to abstract thinking **Decides:** Abstract reasoning is still developing and needs concrete anchors.

A	Correct	Concrete anchors support students moving toward abstract reasoning.
B	Inverted operation	Stays abstract when concrete examples are needed.
C	Camouflage	Technology does not change the level of abstraction.
D	Absolute language	Abstract thinking develops unevenly.

4. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A student can correctly solve $3 + x = 10$ and $5 + x = 12$ but cannot explain what $a + x = b$ means. What does this show?

Target word: read the evidence back to the developmental stage **Decides:** Concrete success with abstract difficulty.

A	Correct	Concrete success plus abstract difficulty fits uneven formal operations.
B	Inverted operation	The concrete problems show addition is understood.
C	Absolute language	Abstract reasoning grows with support.
D	Confusion set	The student cannot yet handle the general form.

5. Answer C Concept 4

Halfway through a unit, a biology teacher ~~who runs the school garden club~~ gives a 10-question quiz on cell organelles. ~~It is printed on bright green paper.~~ She uses the results to regroup students for the next two days of review. How is this quiz being used?

Target word: classify by use of results **Decides:** Results are used to adjust instruction during the unit.

A	Absolute language	Not every quiz is summative.
B	Adjacent category	It was given halfway through, not before.
C	Correct	Formative assessment adjusts teaching during learning.
D	Confusion set	Format does not decide purpose; use does.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A teacher gives the same 10-question quiz but records it as the unit grade and starts the next unit the following day. How is it being used now?

Target word: same format, opposite purpose **Decides:** Results judge learning at the end and do not change instruction.

A	Inverted operation	Same format, but the use has changed.
B	Adjacent category	Diagnostic assessment happens before instruction.
C	Correct	It judges learning at the end of the unit.
D	Confusion set	A performance task asks students to create or do something, not answer quiz items.

7. Answer D Concept 5

An English teacher ~~with 150 students across five periods~~ wants all students to analyze how an author builds suspense. Some students read well above grade level, and some are still building fluency. ~~The school library was recently remodeled.~~ Which plan best differentiates?

Target word: differentiation that keeps the goal **Decides:** Same objective, varied path.

A	Dropped element	Drops the learning goal for some students.
B	Inverted operation	More of the same work is not differentiation.
C	Camouflage	The remodel is irrelevant, and the plan loses the objective.
D	Correct	Varies content and product while keeping the analysis goal.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

Students in a history class all read the same article on the causes of a war. Some write an essay, some build an annotated timeline, and some record a podcast explaining the causes. Which element of instruction is being differentiated?

Target word: name the element from the plan **Decides:** Only the way students show learning varies.

A	Adjacent category	Nothing about the room or grouping changed.
B	Inverted operation	All students explain the same causes; the goal stays fixed.
C	Correct	Students show the same learning in different forms.
D	Confusion set	Everyone read the same article.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A health teacher ~~whose classroom faces the football field~~ writes an objective for a unit on nutrition: Students will choose to read food labels on their own and explain why doing so matters to them. ~~The unit uses a new online textbook.~~ Which domain and level does this objective target?

Target word: domain and level of objective **Decides:** Choosing on one's own and explaining why it matters shows valuing.

A	Confusion set	Receiving is only being willing to attend.
B	Adjacent category	The objective is about commitment, not applying knowledge.
C	Camouflage	Handling a label is not the skill being targeted.
D	Correct	Acting on a commitment and explaining its worth is valuing.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

A teacher wants an objective at the lowest level of the affective domain. Which fits?

Target word: produce the lowest affective level **Decides:** Receiving is the lowest level: willingness to attend.

A	Correct	Attending is receiving.
B	Confusion set	Organizing is the fourth level, not the first.
C	Adjacent category	A cognitive recall objective.
D	Inverted operation	That is characterizing, the highest level.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A history teacher ~~who has used a popular free AI chatbot for two years~~ wants to speed up feedback. He plans to paste students' essays, with their full names and ID numbers, into the chatbot. ~~The chatbot has millions of users.~~ What should he do first?

Target word: privacy step before AI use **Decides:** Identifiable student data is going into a tool not approved by the district.

A	Absolute language	Approved tools used safely can support teaching.
B	Correct	Protects student privacy and follows district policy.
C	Camouflage	Popularity does not show privacy compliance.
D	Adjacent category	Grade level does not change privacy rules.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A science teacher moves from a school with 50-minute periods to a school with 90-minute blocks. ~~His new school is in a larger district with a well-known robotics program.~~ How should he adjust his lesson planning?

Target word: plan for block schedule **Decides:** A 90-minute block needs several chunks and varied activities.

A	Dropped element	Drops the redesign a block requires.
B	Correct	Chunking keeps adolescents engaged across a long block.
C	Camouflage	The robotics program does not decide lesson pacing.
D	Inverted operation	A long single activity ignores attention and pacing.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The still-developing adolescent brain	The reward system matures before the prefrontal cortex, so adolescents benefit from structured choices, clear steps, and chances to plan and reflect.	Reading impulsive choices as defiance or low ability rather than a developmental stage.	A student makes a risky, in-the-moment choice, especially around peers.
2	Identity formation	Adolescents are working out who they are (Erikson: identity vs. role confusion), so relevance, voice, and choice increase engagement.	Treating a need for voice as a classroom-management problem.	Students ask why this matters to them or resist tasks with no personal connection.
3	Uneven abstract reasoning	Formal operational (abstract) thinking emerges gradually and unevenly, so abstract ideas need concrete anchors first.	Assuming every teenager can already reason fully in the abstract.	Students can do a concrete example but stall on the general rule.
4	Formative vs. summative purpose	Formative assessment gathers evidence during learning to adjust teaching; summative assessment judges learning at the end.	Classifying an assessment by its format rather than how its results are used.	The question says what the teacher does with the results.
5	Differentiating content, process, and product	Differentiation changes how students get content, make sense of it, or show it, while the learning goal stays the same.	Differentiating by lowering the goal or giving advanced students more of the same work.	Options vary the path while one objective is named.
6	The affective domain	Affective objectives run from receiving to responding, valuing, organizing, and characterizing (Krathwohl); each level shows deeper commitment.	Treating attitudes and values as untestable, or confusing affective levels with cognitive ones.	An objective about attitudes, willingness, or values.
7	AI tools and student data privacy	Teachers use AI tools only in ways that protect student privacy: no identifiable student information in unapproved tools, and district policy comes first.	Assuming a popular or free tool is automatically safe for student records.	A teacher is about to paste student work, names, or grades into an AI tool.
8	Planning for the secondary setting	Secondary structures (period length, block schedules, departmentalization, many students per day) shape instructional choices such as chunking and pacing.	Planning one long activity for a 90-minute block as if it were a 45-minute period.	The schedule or setting is named and the question asks about lesson design.

Course scope (public description): General Secondary Methods prepares students for secondary teaching by equipping them with essential instructional skills and knowledge tailored to adolescent learners. Students will explore how adolescent development influences learning, how secondary school settings influence instructional choices, and how to implement effective teaching strategies in these environments. Through a blend of theory and practical application, students will create and assess lesson plans, focusing on differentiated instruction, formative

and summative assessments, and the integration of technology, including AI tools, to promote affective learning in diverse secondary education settings.